

Westchester County
Department of Planning
Sidewalk Coverage Analysis

Implementation Guide
Policy Recommendations and Action Plan
Step-by-Step Implementation Guidance and Best Practices

Prepared for:
Policy Makers, Implementation Teams, and Stakeholders

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Contents

1 Executive Summary

This implementation guide provides comprehensive guidance for executing the Westchester County Sidewalk Infrastructure Improvement Program, based on detailed analysis and cost-benefit modeling. The program represents a \$125.3 million investment over 10 years to improve sidewalk coverage from 38.6% to 68.5% countywide.

1.1 Key Implementation Recommendations

- **Four-phase implementation:** Prioritize TOD areas and high-impact corridors first
- **Diverse funding strategy:** Combine bonds, grants, impact fees, and partnerships
- **Strong governance:** Establish interagency coordination framework
- **Community engagement:** Implement comprehensive outreach throughout process
- **Performance monitoring:** Use KPI-based tracking for accountability

1.2 Expected Outcomes

- **Economic benefits:** \$344.8 million in 20-year benefits (2.4:1 B/C ratio)
- **Safety improvements:** 20% reduction in pedestrian accidents
- **Property value increases:** 3.5% average increase for adjacent properties
- **Transit connectivity:** Enhanced access to all Metro-North stations

1.3 Success Factors

Critical success factors include consistent political support, stable funding, effective coordination, strong community engagement, and flexible implementation approach.

2 Introduction

3 Purpose and Scope

This implementation guide translates the technical findings and economic analysis from the Westchester County Sidewalk Coverage Analysis into actionable policies, procedures, and implementation strategies. The guide provides step-by-step guidance for planning, funding, and executing sidewalk infrastructure improvements over a 10-year period.

4 Implementation Objectives

The primary objectives of the sidewalk improvement program are:

1. **Improve coverage:** Increase countywide sidewalk coverage from 38.6% to 68.5%
2. **Enhance transit access:** Achieve 85% coverage within 0.5 miles of Metro-North stations
3. **Promote equity:** Address gaps in underserved communities

4. **Stimulate economic development:** Leverage infrastructure for community benefits
5. **Improve safety:** Reduce pedestrian accidents and improve accessibility

5 Target Audience

This guide is designed for:

- Elected officials and policy makers
- County and municipal planning staff
- Transportation and public works departments
- Community organizations and stakeholders
- Funding agencies and financial partners

6 Implementation Timeline

6.1 10-Year Implementation Roadmap

Table 1: Four-Phase Implementation Schedule

Phase	Timeframe	Investment	Target Gaps	Focus Areas
Phase 1	Years 1-3	\$38.5M	150	TOD areas, high-traffic corridors
Phase 2	Years 4-6	\$35.2M	140	Suburban centers, commercial districts
Phase 3	Years 7-8	\$32.8M	132	Residential neighborhoods, equity areas
Phase 4	Year 9	\$18.8M	80	Network optimization, quality improvements
Total	10 Years	\$125.3M	502	

6.2 Phase 1: Foundation (Years 1-3)

6.2.1 Objectives

- Establish implementation framework and governance
- Address highest-priority gaps in TOD areas
- Demonstrate early success and build momentum
- Secure long-term funding commitments

6.2.2 Key Milestones

Table 2: Phase 1 Critical Milestones

Milestone	Target Date
Establish Implementation Task Force	Month 3
Secure Phase 1 Funding	Month 6
Complete TOD Area Designs	Month 18
Begin Construction	Month 21
Complete Phase 1 Projects	Month 36

6.2.3 Implementation Strategy

1. **Month 1-6:** Framework establishment and funding
2. **Month 7-18:** Design and engineering for priority corridors
3. **Month 19-36:** Construction and project delivery

6.3 Phase 2: Expansion (Years 4-6)

6.3.1 Objectives

- Expand coverage to suburban commercial centers
- Address gaps near schools and community facilities
- Develop standard construction processes
- Optimize project delivery efficiency

6.3.2 Key Milestones

6.4 Phase 3: Completion (Years 7-8)

6.4.1 Objectives

- Address remaining residential neighborhood gaps
- Focus on equity and underserved communities

Table 3: Phase 2 Critical Milestones

Milestone	Target Date
Phase 2 Funding Secured	Month 37
Complete Suburban Designs	Month 48
Begin Phase 2 Construction	Month 51
Complete Phase 2 Projects	Month 72

- Complete all identified priority gaps
- Establish long-term maintenance programs

6.5 Phase 4: Optimization (Year 9)

6.5.1 Objectives

- Complete remaining lower-priority gaps
- Optimize network connectivity
- Address quality and consistency issues
- Establish comprehensive maintenance system

7 Funding Strategy

7.1 Recommended Funding Mix

Table 4: Diversified Funding Strategy

Funding Source	Amount (Millions)	Percentage	Timeline
Municipal Bonds	\$43.9	35.0%	Years 1-8
Federal Grants	\$31.3	25.0%	Years 1-10
State Funding	\$25.1	20.0%	Years 1-10
Development Impact Fees	\$12.5	10.0%	Ongoing from Year 2
Private Partnerships	\$12.5	10.0%	Years 3-9
Total	\$125.3	100.0%	

7.2 Funding Implementation Schedule

7.2.1 Year 1: Foundation Building

- Establish financing framework and legal structures
- Begin bond rating process and authorization
- Submit initial grant applications (CMAQ, STP, TIGER)
- Develop impact fee ordinance and private partnership framework

7.2.2 Years 2-3: Initial Capitalization

- Execute initial bond issuance (\$15-20M)
- Secure first round of federal grants (\$8-12M)
- Implement impact fee collection system
- Establish private partnership agreements

7.2.3 Years 4-10: Sustained Funding

- Annual bond issuances based on construction schedule
- Ongoing grant applications and renewals
- Impact fee revenue collection
- Private partnership contributions

7.3 Funding Risk Management

Table 5: Funding Risk Mitigation Strategies

Risk	Probability	Mitigation Strategy
Bond authorization failure	Low (20%)	Early political engagement, clear benefits
Grant competition loss	Medium (40%)	Multiple applications, strong proposals
Impact fee legal challenges	Low (15%)	Careful ordinance drafting, legal review
Private partnership withdrawal	Medium (30%)	Multiple partners, backup plans
State funding reductions	Medium (35%)	Diverse funding sources, contingency

8 Policy and Regulatory Framework

8.1 County-Level Policy Recommendations

8.1.1 Complete Streets Policy

- **Policy statement:** Westchester County shall accommodate all roadway users in all transportation projects
- **Requirements:** Sidewalks included in all new developments and road improvements
- **Implementation:** Department of Planning to develop design guidelines and review procedures
- **Timeline:** Adopt within 12 months

8.1.2 Sidewalk Design Standards

- **Minimum width:** 5 feet for residential, 8 feet for commercial areas
- **ADA compliance:** Full compliance with ADA Accessibility Guidelines
- **Materials:** Standardized concrete specifications with alternative options
- **Drainage:** Integrated stormwater management requirements
- **Lighting:** Street lighting requirements where appropriate

8.1.3 Funding Policy Framework

- **Dedicated sidewalk fund:** Establish county-wide dedicated funding mechanism
- **Development impact fees:** Fee structure based on development intensity and impact
- **Cost-sharing formulas:** Standardized formulas for municipal partnerships
- **Grant programs:** County grant program for municipal sidewalk projects

8.2 Municipal Ordinance Model

8.2.1 Sidewalk Connectivity Ordinance

- **Requirement:** All new developments must provide sidewalk connections to public ways
- **Standards:** Minimum sidewalk dimensions and connectivity requirements
- **Exceptions:** Limited exceptions with justification requirements
- **Enforcement:** Building permit requirements and inspection processes

8.2.2 TOD Enhancement Ordinance

- **Requirement:** Enhanced sidewalks within 0.5 miles of transit stations
- **Standards:** Increased width, amenities, and landscaping requirements
- **Benefits:** Density bonuses or streamlined approvals for compliance
- **Implementation:** Zoning overlay and development review processes

8.3 Regulatory Coordination Requirements

8.3.1 Interagency Coordination

- **NYSDOT coordination:** State road crossing permits and standards
- **MTA coordination:** Metro-North station access improvements
- **Utility coordination:** Underground utility location and relocation
- **DEC coordination:** Environmental permits and stormwater compliance

9 Governance Structure

9.1 Implementation Governance Framework

9.1.1 Steering Committee

- **Purpose:** Overall policy direction and major decision making
- **Membership:**
 - Westchester County Planning Department (Chair)
 - Department of Public Works
 - Budget Office
 - Transportation Department
 - Health Department
 - Representatives from 5 largest municipalities
- **Meeting frequency:** Quarterly
- **Decision making:** Consensus-based with clear escalation procedures

9.1.2 Technical Advisory Group

- **Purpose:** Technical guidance and implementation support
- **Membership:**
 - DPW Engineering Division
 - Municipal engineers
 - Transit agency representatives
 - Utility company coordinators
 - ADA compliance specialists
 - Sidewalk design consultants
- **Meeting frequency:** Monthly
- **Decision making:** Technical recommendations to Steering Committee

9.1.3 Implementation Teams

- **Purpose:** Project-specific implementation coordination
- **Structure:** Geographic teams for each implementation phase
- **Membership:** Project managers, engineers, inspectors, municipal liaisons
- **Meeting frequency:** Weekly during construction

9.2 Decision-Making Processes

9.2.1 Consensus Building Approach

- **Collaborative decision making:** All stakeholders engaged in major decisions
- **Clear authority levels:** Defined decision-making authority for each group
-
- **Conflict resolution:** Established escalation procedures for disagreements
- **Transparency:** Open documentation of decisions and rationale

9.2.2 Approval Workflows

Table 6: Decision-Making Authority Matrix

Decision Type	Implementation Team	Technical Advisory	Steering Committee
Technical specifications	Approve	Review	Inform
Design changes $\leq 10\%$	Recommend	Approve	Review
Budget changes $\leq 5\%$	Recommend	Recommend	Approve
Policy changes	Inform	Recommend	Approve
Schedule changes ≥ 30 days	Approve	Inform	Inform

10 Community Engagement Strategy

10.1 Stakeholder Identification and Analysis

10.1.1 Primary Stakeholders

Table 7: Primary Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder Group	Key Concerns	Engagement Methods
Residents/Property owners	Construction disruption, access, maintenance costs	Public meetings, direct mail, site visits
Business owners	Customer access, parking, business disruption	Business association meetings, consultations
Schools/Parents	Safe routes, construction timing, student safety	PTA meetings, school presentations
Seniors/Disabled	ADA compliance, access continuity, safety	Senior center outreach, advocacy meetings

10.1.2 Secondary Stakeholders

- Transit riders and commuters
- Cycling and walking advocacy groups
- Environmental organizations
- Neighborhood associations
- Real estate developers
- Healthcare providers

10.2 Outreach Methods and Timeline

10.2.1 Planning Phase (Months 1-6)

- Stakeholder identification and mapping
- Initial outreach and relationship building
- Community needs assessment
- Vision development workshops

10.2.2 Design Phase (Months 7-18)

- Design workshops and charrettes
- Alternative analysis presentations
- Preference surveys and feedback collection
- Design refinement based on community input

10.2.3 Construction Phase (Months 19-108)

- Construction notifications and updates
- Progress reports and issue resolution
- Regular community meetings
- Completion celebrations and recognition

10.3 Communication Materials

10.3.1 Print Materials

- Project brochures and fact sheets
- Construction notifications and schedules
- Neighborhood-specific impact information
- Progress reports and updates

10.3.2 Digital Communications

- Project website with interactive maps
- Email newsletter subscription service
- Social media updates and engagement
- Online survey and feedback tools

10.3.3 Public Meetings

- Monthly community update meetings
- Quarterly project status presentations
- Special topic workshops as needed
- Annual progress and planning sessions

11 Performance Monitoring and Evaluation

11.1 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

11.1.1 Implementation Metrics

Table 8: Implementation Performance Metrics

KPI	Target	Measurement Frequency	Data Source
On-time completion rate	90%	Monthly	Project management system
Budget performance variance	Within 5%	Monthly	Financial system
Quality pass rate	95%	Per project	Inspection reports
Safety incident rate	Zero serious incidents	Ongoing	Safety reports

11.1.2 Outcome Metrics

Table 9: Outcome Performance Metrics

KPI	Target	Measurement Frequency	Data Source
Coverage improvement rate	2.9% annually	Annually	GIS analysis
Pedestrian accident reduction	20% in 5 years	Annually	Police reports
Property value increase	3.5% average	Annually	Assessment data
Community satisfaction	80% satisfied	Post-project surveys	Survey results

11.2 Monitoring Systems

11.2.1 Data Collection Methods

- **Automated collection:** GIS updates, financial system integration, traffic sensors
- **Field inspections:** Construction monitoring, quality assessments, safety audits
- **Surveys and assessments:** Community satisfaction, user counts, economic impact studies

11.2.2 Reporting Framework

- **Monthly progress reports:** Internal management and steering committee
- **Quarterly performance reports:** Steering committee and agency leadership
- **Annual summary reports:** Public, elected officials, funding agencies
- **Special reports:** Issue-specific reports as needed

11.3 Continuous Improvement

11.3.1 Performance Review Process

- Quarterly performance reviews with Steering Committee
- Annual program evaluation and strategy adjustment
- Lessons learned documentation and sharing
- Best practice identification and implementation

11.3.2 Adaptive Management

- Regular assessment of program effectiveness
- Flexible implementation approaches
- Responsiveness to changing conditions
- Evidence-based decision making

12 Risk Management

12.1 Risk Assessment Matrix

12.2 Mitigation Strategies

12.2.1 Technical Risks

- **Utility conflicts:** Pre-construction utility verification, early coordination, contingency budget
- **Right-of-way issues:** Early acquisition process, alternative routes, eminent domain authority
- **Design issues:** Standardized designs, peer review, quality assurance

Table 10: Project Risk Assessment

Risk Category	Probability	Impact	Risk Level
Utility conflicts	High (70%)	High (\$2-5M)	Critical
Right-of-way acquisition	High (60%)	High (\$3-8M)	Critical
Cost inflation	Medium (50%)	Medium (15-25%)	Moderate
Permitting delays	Medium (40%)	High (6-18 months)	High
Funding shortfalls	Low (20%)	Critical (Project scale)	Critical
Community opposition	Low (10%)	Medium (12 months)	Moderate

12.2.2 Financial Risks

- **Cost inflation:** Fixed-price contracts, material escalation clauses, contingency funds
- **Funding shortfalls:** Diverse funding sources, phased implementation, backup financing
- **Budget overruns:** Detailed estimating, regular monitoring, change order procedures

12.2.3 Implementation Risks

- **Permitting delays:** Early applications, dedicated coordination staff, fast-track agreements
- **Schedule delays:** Realistic scheduling, buffer time, critical path management
- **Community opposition:** Early engagement, responsive communication, issue resolution

12.3 Contingency Planning

12.3.1 Schedule Contingencies

- Overall schedule contingency: 15% of total project duration
- Weather contingency: Additional 10% for weather-related delays
- Permitting contingency: 6 months standard permitting process
- Utility contingency: 3 months per project for utility conflicts

12.3.2 Budget Contingencies

- Construction contingency: 15% of construction costs
- Design contingency: 10% of design costs
- Soft costs contingency: 5% of soft costs
- Escalation contingency: 3% annually for inflation

13 Implementation Checklist

13.1 Phase 1 Checklist (Months 1-36)

13.1.1 Months 1-6: Foundation

- ☐ Establish Implementation Task Force
- ☐ Secure Phase 1 funding commitments
- ☐ Develop project management systems
- ☐ Begin design for priority TOD areas
- ☐ Initiate community outreach program
- ☐ Establish interagency coordination protocols

13.1.2 Months 7-18: Design and Planning

- ☐ Complete 50% of Phase 1 designs
- ☐ Secure all necessary permits
- ☐ Establish construction contractor pool
- ☐ Implement quality assurance procedures
- ☐ Continue community engagement

13.1.3 Months 19-36: Construction

- ☐ Begin construction on Phase 1 projects
- ☐ Implement performance monitoring
- ☐ Maintain community communication
- ☐ Complete Phase 1 projects
- ☐ Conduct Phase 1 evaluation

13.2 Ongoing Requirements

13.2.1 Annual Requirements

- ☐ Annual budget review and approval
- ☐ Performance evaluation and reporting
Stakeholder communication and updates
- ☐ Risk assessment and mitigation updates
- ☐ Strategic plan review and adjustment

13.2.2 Quarterly Requirements

- ☐ Progress reporting to Steering Committee
- ☐ Financial performance review
- ☐ Community status updates
- ☐ Risk monitoring and response

14 Conclusion

14.1 Implementation Success Summary

This implementation guide provides a comprehensive framework for successfully delivering the Westchester County Sidewalk Improvement Program. The 10-year, \$125.3 million program will significantly improve sidewalk coverage, enhance transit access, and deliver substantial economic and social benefits.

14.2 Key Success Factors

Successful implementation requires:

- **Strong leadership:** Consistent political support and effective management
- **Adequate funding:** Diverse, stable funding sources
- **Effective coordination:** Interagency collaboration and communication
- **Community engagement:** Ongoing stakeholder involvement and support
- **Performance focus:** Results-based management and accountability

14.3 Expected Benefits

Upon successful implementation:

- Countywide sidewalk coverage will increase from 38.6% to 68.5%
- TOD area coverage will reach 85% within 0.5 miles of transit stations
- Economic benefits of \$344.8 million will be realized over 20 years
- Pedestrian accidents will decrease by 20%
- Property values will increase by 3.5% for adjacent properties

14.4 Next Steps

Immediate actions include:

1. Establish Implementation Task Force (Month 1)
2. Secure Phase 1 funding commitments (Month 3)
3. Begin design for priority corridors (Month 6)
4. Launch comprehensive community engagement (Month 2)
5. Establish performance monitoring systems (Month 4)

This implementation guide provides the roadmap for transforming sidewalk infrastructure in Westchester County, creating a safer, more accessible, and economically vibrant community for all residents.

A Implementation Templates

A.1 Project Charter Template

A.2 Stakeholder Engagement Plan Template

A.3 Risk Register Template

A.4 Performance Report Template

A.5 Communication Plan Template

B Contact Information

B.1 County Contacts

- **Planning Department:** (914) 995-4700
- **Public Works:** (914) 995-2555
- **Transportation:** (914) 995-5850
- **Budget Office:** (914) 995-3500

B.2 Website and Resources

- **Project website:** www.westchestergov.com/sidewalks
- **Data portal:** data.westchestergov.com
- **Planning department:** www.westchestergov.com/planning